

ASIMO

Advanced Step in Innovative Mobility by Honda

The Grandfather of Modern Humanoids

Introduced in 2000, ASIMO was the culmination of decades of bipedal robotics research by Honda that began in the 1980s. Standing at 130 cm (4 ft 3 in) and resembling a tiny astronaut, ASIMO captured the world's imagination and became a global ambassador for Japanese technological prowess.

Groundbreaking Capabilities

At its peak, ASIMO showcased abilities that were years ahead of its time. It could run at speeds up to 9 km/h, climb stairs smoothly, hop on one foot, pour drinks into paper cups without crushing them, and recognize moving objects, postures, and gestures.

Technological Innovations

ASIMO utilized a predictive movement control technology called i-WALK, which allowed it to proactively shift its center of gravity before initiating a turn, making its walking motion remarkably human-like compared to other robots of the era.

Although Honda announced the cessation of ASIMO's development in 2018 to focus on practical applications like nursing care robots and autonomous vehicles, ASIMO's legacy lives on. It fundamentally proved that dynamic bipedal walking was possible and inspired a generation of roboticists.